ON THE FAST TRACK

Travel turns seamless as FASTag, a small sticker on your car, opens up toll gateways

By AVISHEK G. DASTIDAR

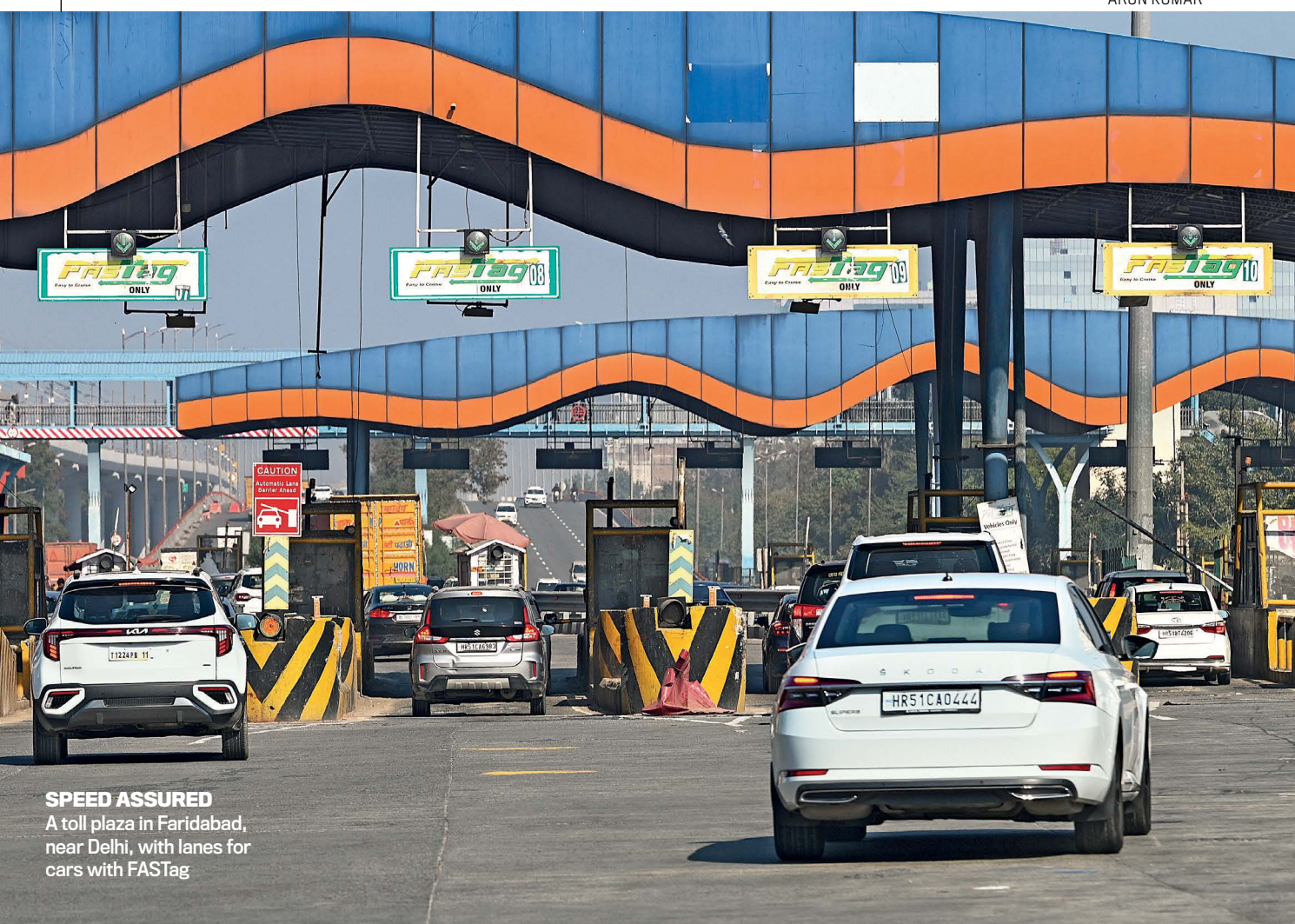
THE DRUDGERY

Less than 10 years ago, driving on India's highways was an exercise in patience that would test even the coolest of drivers. Just when you thought you were making good time on your road trip, a toll plaza would loom ahead, with a long line of cars in queue, as drivers fumbled with cash and argued over exact change. Sometimes, there would be violence. Rush hours and holiday season compounded the ordeal, when the long wait could last hours. Trucks and commercial vehicles fared worse, as waiting at the toll plaza not only meant wastage of fuel but also a disruption in delivery schedules. Manual systems meant limited transparency plus revenue leaks. Toll workers grappled

FASTAG PROJECT
Launched in 2014

Achievement: FASTag has brought down wait time at a toll plaza from 734 seconds to 47 seconds. The aim now is to reduce it to 10 seconds

ARUN KUMAR



SPEED ASSURED
A toll plaza in Faridabad, near Delhi, with lanes for cars with FASTag